

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | Course Knowledge Profile

Identity, purpose, prerequisites, scope and boundaries

Category	Design & Creative
Target learners	Creative learners targeting visual, brand and social-media design roles.
Prerequisites	Basic computer use; drawing ability is helpful but not mandatory.
Approved duration	Approved working range: 12-16 weeks / 140-180 guided hours.
Final outcome	Create coherent digital and print designs using typography, layout, image editing, vector graphics and a documented design process.
Assessment profile	Creative

Approved tools / platforms

Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator and relevant layout/prototyping tools; exact licensed software and versions to confirm.

Knowledge boundaries

Include	Quality rule	Exclude / escalate
The eight approved modules, four sections, named tools, projects and mapped entry-level roles.	Require the brief, working/source files, design rationale, iteration evidence, technical quality and accessible export.	Do not treat a copied template or final export alone as proof of original process and ownership.
Current product/platform procedures only when version and date are known.	Use primary documentation and record the source version.	Do not invent current commands, prices, tax rates, policies or certification status.
Evidence-based career guidance.	Cite tests, projects, capstone, viva and verified resume evidence.	No guaranteed job, placement, salary, interview or employer claim.

LLM answer pattern: identify the course and version, answer from approved records, cite record IDs, distinguish verified facts from guidance, and state any missing evidence.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | NT-C-009-S01 Deep Knowledge

Modules 1-2 | objectives, concepts, evidence and remediation

Section competency	Composition, hierarchy, colour, typography; Selections, masks, retouching, composites
Completion evidence	Design-principles exercises; Edited image series
Section weight	20% of the weighted mock-test average
Assessment	8 knowledge items (20 marks) + 2 critique/scenario items (20) + 1 timed artifact brief with rubric (60)

Module 1 - Design foundation

Objective: Composition, hierarchy, colour, typography

Observable evidence: Design-principles exercises

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Composition	The arrangement of visual elements to guide attention and communicate meaning. In Graphic Design, it must be demonstrated through an observable task, not only recalled as a definition.	Explain when composition is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Design-principles exercises
hierarchy	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when hierarchy is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Design-principles exercises
colour	The controlled use of hue, value and contrast for communication, consistency and accessibility. In Graphic Design, it must be demonstrated through an observable task, not only recalled as a definition.	Explain when colour is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Design-principles exercises
typography	The structured use of type to support hierarchy, readability and visual meaning. In Graphic Design, it must be demonstrated through an observable task, not only recalled as a definition.	Explain when typography is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Design-principles exercises

Module 2 - Image editing

Objective: Selections, masks, retouching, composites

Observable evidence: Edited image series

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Selections	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when selections is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Edited image series
masks	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when masks is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Edited image series
retouching	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when retouching is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Edited image series
composites	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when composites is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Edited image series

Remediation: If the learner cannot explain the purpose, complete the stated task or provide Design-principles exercises; Edited image series, return to Modules 1-2, complete one guided practice and then use a new equivalent test form.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | NT-C-009-S02 Deep Knowledge

Modules 3-4 | objectives, concepts, evidence and remediation

Section competency	Shapes, pen tool, icons, logo construction; Grid, spacing, type systems, consistency
Completion evidence	Vector identity assets; Multi-page layout
Section weight	25% of the weighted mock-test average
Assessment	8 knowledge items (20 marks) + 2 critique/scenario items (20) + 1 timed artifact brief with rubric (60)

Module 3 - Vector design

Objective: Shapes, pen tool, icons, logo construction

Observable evidence: Vector identity assets

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Shapes	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when shapes is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Vector identity assets
pen tool	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when pen tool is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Vector identity assets
icons	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when icons is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Vector identity assets
logo construction	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when logo construction is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Vector identity assets

Module 4 - Layout systems

Objective: Grid, spacing, type systems, consistency

Observable evidence: Multi-page layout

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Grid	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when grid is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Multi-page layout
spacing	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when spacing is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Multi-page layout
type systems	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when type systems is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Multi-page layout
consistency	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when consistency is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Multi-page layout

Remediation: If the learner cannot explain the purpose, complete the stated task or provide Vector identity assets; Multi-page layout, return to Modules 3-4, complete one guided practice and then use a new equivalent test form.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | NT-C-009-S03 Deep Knowledge

Modules 5-6 | objectives, concepts, evidence and remediation

Section competency	Research, logo, colour/type, guidelines; Social posts, display ads, thumbnails
Completion evidence	Mini brand system; Campaign creative set
Section weight	25% of the weighted mock-test average
Assessment	8 knowledge items (20 marks) + 2 critique/scenario items (20) + 1 timed artifact brief with rubric (60)

Module 5 - Brand identity

Objective: Research, logo, colour/type, guidelines

Observable evidence: Mini brand system

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Research	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when research is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Mini brand system
logo	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when logo is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Mini brand system
colour/type	The controlled use of hue, value and contrast for communication, consistency and accessibility. In Graphic Design, it must be demonstrated through an observable task, not only recalled as a definition.	Explain when colour/type is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Mini brand system
guidelines	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when guidelines is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Mini brand system

Module 6 - Campaign design

Objective: Social posts, display ads, thumbnails

Observable evidence: Campaign creative set

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Social posts	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when social posts is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Campaign creative set
display ads	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when display ads is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Campaign creative set
thumbnails	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when thumbnails is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Campaign creative set

Remediation: If the learner cannot explain the purpose, complete the stated task or provide Mini brand system; Campaign creative set, return to Modules 5-6, complete one guided practice and then use a new equivalent test form.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | NT-C-009-S04 Deep Knowledge

Modules 7-8 | objectives, concepts, evidence and remediation

Section competency	Bleed, colour modes, export, preflight; Brief, concepts, iteration, presentation
Completion evidence	Print-ready artwork; Case-study portfolio
Section weight	30% of the weighted mock-test average
Assessment	8 knowledge items (20 marks) + 2 critique/scenario items (20) + 1 timed artifact brief with rubric (60)

Module 7 - Print & production

Objective: Bleed, colour modes, export, preflight

Observable evidence: Print-ready artwork

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Bleed	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when bleed is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Print-ready artwork
colour modes	The controlled use of hue, value and contrast for communication, consistency and accessibility. In Graphic Design, it must be demonstrated through an observable task, not only recalled as a definition.	Explain when colour modes is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Print-ready artwork
export	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when export is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Print-ready artwork
preflight	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when preflight is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Print-ready artwork

Module 8 - Portfolio capstone

Objective: Brief, concepts, iteration, presentation

Observable evidence: Case-study portfolio

Concept	Approved knowledge statement	Application behaviour	Evidence
Brief	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when brief is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Case-study portfolio
concepts	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when concepts is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Case-study portfolio
iteration	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when iteration is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Case-study portfolio
presentation	A defined competency within Graphic Design. The learner must explain its purpose, apply it in an appropriate scenario, verify the result and produce the specified evidence.	Explain when presentation is appropriate; apply it in a Graphic Design task; verify the result.	Case-study portfolio

Remediation: If the learner cannot explain the purpose, complete the stated task or provide Print-ready artwork; Case-study portfolio, return to Modules 7-8, complete one guided practice and then use a new equivalent test form.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | Skill Ontology & Dependency Map

Atomic skills, learning order and evidence strength

Skill ID	Competency	Depends on	Evidence	Type
NT-C-009-SK01	Design foundation	Prerequisite foundation	Design-principles exercises	Critical
NT-C-009-SK02	Image editing	M01 plus earlier foundations	Edited image series	Critical
NT-C-009-SK03	Vector design	M02 plus earlier foundations	Vector identity assets	Supporting
NT-C-009-SK04	Layout systems	M03 plus earlier foundations	Multi-page layout	Supporting
NT-C-009-SK05	Brand identity	M04 plus earlier foundations	Mini brand system	Supporting
NT-C-009-SK06	Campaign design	M05 plus earlier foundations	Campaign creative set	Critical
NT-C-009-SK07	Print & production	M06 plus earlier foundations	Print-ready artwork	Supporting
NT-C-009-SK08	Portfolio capstone	M07 plus earlier foundations	Case-study portfolio	Critical

Evidence-strength hierarchy

Strength	Evidence source	Use
High	Trainer-observed practical, viva, working source/project files and reproducible output.	May support verified mastery when rubric threshold is met.
Medium	Scored mock tests, reviewed assignments and documented portfolio artifacts.	Supports mastery with corroboration.
Low	Resume claim, self-report, attendance or video completion without demonstration.	May trigger verification; cannot alone support Apply Now.

CareerTours must not treat attendance, time spent or content opened as skill mastery.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | Assessment Knowledge & Sample Items

Non-live examples for LLM training and evaluation

Sample ID	Type	Question	Approved answer / rubric anchor
NT-C-009-S01-EX01	Evidence/application	What evidence best demonstrates the combined competency of Design foundation and Image editing?	The learner should provide Design-principles exercises; Edited image series and explain how the work applies Composition, hierarchy, colour, typography; Selections, masks, retouching, composites. Recall alone is insufficient.
NT-C-009-S01-EX02	Scenario/remediation	A learner reports completing Image editing but cannot produce Edited image series. What should CareerTours do?	Mark the evidence Not Yet Verified, assign practice from NT-C-009-S01, request Edited image series, and allow a new equivalent test only after remediation.
NT-C-009-S02-EX01	Evidence/application	What evidence best demonstrates the combined competency of Vector design and Layout systems?	The learner should provide Vector identity assets; Multi-page layout and explain how the work applies Shapes, pen tool, icons, logo construction; Grid, spacing, type systems, consistency. Recall alone is insufficient.
NT-C-009-S02-EX02	Scenario/remediation	A learner reports completing Layout systems but cannot produce Multi-page layout. What should CareerTours do?	Mark the evidence Not Yet Verified, assign practice from NT-C-009-S02, request Multi-page layout, and allow a new equivalent test only after remediation.
NT-C-009-S03-EX01	Evidence/application	What evidence best demonstrates the combined competency of Brand identity and Campaign design?	The learner should provide Mini brand system; Campaign creative set and explain how the work applies Research, logo, colour/type, guidelines; Social posts, display ads, thumbnails. Recall alone is insufficient.
NT-C-009-S03-EX02	Scenario/remediation	A learner reports completing Campaign design but cannot produce Campaign creative set. What should CareerTours do?	Mark the evidence Not Yet Verified, assign practice from NT-C-009-S03, request Campaign creative set, and allow a new equivalent test only after remediation.
NT-C-009-S04-EX01	Evidence/application	What evidence best demonstrates the combined competency of Print & production and Portfolio capstone?	The learner should provide Print-ready artwork; Case-study portfolio and explain how the work applies Bleed, colour modes, export, preflight; Brief, concepts, iteration, presentation. Recall alone is insufficient.
NT-C-009-S04-EX02	Scenario/remediation	A learner reports completing Portfolio capstone but cannot produce Case-study portfolio. What should CareerTours do?	Mark the evidence Not Yet Verified, assign practice from NT-C-009-S04, request Case-study portfolio, and allow a new equivalent test only after remediation.

Live bank rule: Generate at least three times the live quantity for each section using the approved Creative blueprint. Human-review every scored item before initial production release.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | Labs, Projects & Scoring Rubrics

Practical proof of learning and ownership

Level	Approved project	Skills evidenced	Required deliverables
Mini 1	Social campaign creative set	Layout, typography, image editing	Brief; working/source file or reproducible environment; output; validation notes; reflection.
Mini 2	Logo and mini brand guide	Vector design, brand system	Brief; working/source file or reproducible environment; output; validation notes; reflection.
Capstone	Multi-channel identity campaign	Research, production, presentation	Brief; working/source file or reproducible environment; output; validation notes; reflection.

Standard project rubric

Dimension	Weight	What earns credit
Problem framing	15%	Clear objective, user/business need, assumptions and success criteria.
Technical/design accuracy	25%	Correct methods, appropriate tools and sound decisions.
Completeness	15%	Required features, assets, data or workflow are present.
Testing and validation	15%	Important normal, edge, quality or failure cases are checked.
Evidence and reproducibility	15%	Source/working files, setup, inputs, outputs and version information are available.
Documentation	5%	Concise structure, instructions and limitations.
Viva / ownership	10%	Learner can explain decisions, demonstrate work and respond to a change request.

Require the brief, working/source files, design rationale, iteration evidence, technical quality and accessible export.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | Career Roles, Evidence & Gap Actions

Explainable top-three occupation matching

Rank	Occupation	Default weighted skills	Minimum evidence	Gap action
1	Junior Graphic Designer	Layout 34% [critical]; typography 33% [critical]; image/vector tools 33%	Curated design portfolio	If a critical skill is below 60 or curated design portfolio is missing, return Improve First or Needs Evidence with the linked module/project.
2	Brand / Visual Design Associate	Identity systems 50% [critical]; presentation 50% [critical]	Brand case study	If a critical skill is below 60 or brand case study is missing, return Improve First or Needs Evidence with the linked module/project.
3	Social Media Designer	Campaign formats 34% [critical]; speed 33% [critical]; consistency 33%	Social creative series	If a critical skill is below 60 or social creative series is missing, return Improve First or Needs Evidence with the linked module/project.

Course readiness	45% section mocks + 20% mini projects + 25% capstone + 10% viva.
Role readiness	45% role-relevant mastery + 25% projects/capstone + 20% aligned mocks + 10% verified resume evidence.
Evidence confidence	Show separately; Apply Now requires at least 70.
Resume extraction	Use only relevant skills, projects, education, experience and portfolio evidence; minimise personal data before external model processing.

A student may be Apply Now for one mapped occupation and Improve First for another. Return independent evidence and gaps for each role.

NT-C-009 | Graphic Design | FAQs, Misconceptions & LLM Response Pack

Course-specific retrieval and response patterns

Approved FAQ	Answer
Who is Graphic Design for?	Creative learners targeting visual, brand and social-media design roles.
What should I know before starting?	Basic computer use; drawing ability is helpful but not mandatory.
How long is the approved learning journey?	Approved working range: 12-16 weeks / 140-180 guided hours.
What will I be able to demonstrate?	Create coherent digital and print designs using typography, layout, image editing, vector graphics and a documented design process.
Does completion guarantee a job?	No. Completion and role readiness are evidence-based guidance; employment, placement, salary and employer selection are not guaranteed.
What if I fail a section?	CareerTours identifies the failed skill tags and module, assigns targeted practice, and permits an equivalent retest after remediation.

Misconception	Approved correction
Attendance proves mastery	False - require tests and observable practical/project evidence.
One total score proves every role fit	False - calculate each occupation using its weighted skills and evidence.
The LLM can add missing details	False - retrieve approved records or state that evidence is insufficient.
Course completion guarantees employment	False - never claim guaranteed job, placement, salary or interview.
Graphic Design knowledge never changes	False - version-sensitive tools, laws, taxes, security and platform procedures require review.

Retrieval metadata

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course_code=NT-C-009; corpus_version=3.0;
record_types=course_profile,module,section,skill,assessment_sample,project,occupation_mapping,faq,misconception;
approval_status=approved; effective_date=2026-08-12
```